

capitalist machine. Even land-based fortunes, of which there are many, are usually the result of rising demand and increased prices caused by the pressure of a growing capitalist economy.

Obviously, the ways in which you can make your family fortune in the modern capitalist era are as varied as the ways it can be lost. But there are some ways *not* to make it.

NOT SO FAST

You don't want to get rich too fast . . . or too easily . . . or by accident. If you get rich by luck alone, you'll probably lose your money as soon as your luck changes. It's much better to get rich from hard work, careful saving, and/or attentive investment in the real economy. Then you'll know how hard it is to come by and be much more careful to hold onto it.

As we say elsewhere in the book, you can have money by accident. You can have a family by accident. But you can't have family money by accident. That's why people who win the lottery, for example, are usually broke within 48 months. And why major sports stars and Hollywood celebrities, who earn millions during a few short years, often end their lives in complete poverty.

Take Travis Henry. He got a \$25 million contract with the Denver Broncos in 2007. Now, he says he's already broke.⁵

Evelyn Adams won the New Jersey lottery twice, in 1985 and 1986. Talk about luck! She won \$5.4 million in total. But don't go looking for Evelyn in a Beverly Hills or Palm Beach mansion. She lives in a trailer.

"Everybody wanted my money. Everybody had their hand out," she says.⁶

Or take the case of William "Bud" Post. He won \$16.2 million in the Pennsylvania lottery in 1988. Think he's fixed for life?

"I wish it never happened. It was totally a nightmare," says Post.

Within a year he was \$1 million in debt and had to declare bankruptcy. Now, he is said to live on food stamps.⁷

Suzanne Mullins won \$4.2 million in the Virginia lottery in 1993. Now she's in debt—with "no assets."